



Kat, I Built This Idea Around You

Happy anniversary · 19 July 2026

Another year of us

And the thing I kept noticing all year

Every time I watched you work this year, I saw the same thing: someone the room trusts completely. Clients hand you their biggest days. You never miss. This gift started as a question — what could I build that deserves her?

VISUAL DIRECTION

a real photo of Kat working (chosen by James), warm-graded.

Layout: photo left half, text right half.



The moment this idea was born

You've solved this problem a thousand times with a tissue

I've watched you tuck a folded tissue under a client's lashes, hold it with one hand, work with the other, and quietly beat a problem the whole beauty industry just tolerates. You told me once it drives you mad. I believed you.

VISUAL DIRECTION

*editorial-style shot of the tissue trick
(real photo or labelled concept image).*

Layout: big quote card style; visual as background at 20% opacity.

Fallout ruins finished faces

A problem every makeup wearer recognises in one second

Shimmer, glitter and pigment drop onto the under-eye and wreck the base beneath. The fixes people use today: tissues, powder, tape, or disposable stickers that cost money forever and can't be repositioned. Time lost, product wasted, photos spoiled.

VISUAL DIRECTION

split image — pristine base vs fallout-dusted under-eye (real demo photo when available; label any concept image).

Layout: split-screen comparison.

Everyone has the problem. Nobody owns it.

What the research actually found

Disposable shields sell worldwide (one brand made Oprah's magazine) — but they're consumables with complaints. Reusable versions exist as \$6 generic paddles with no fit, no brand, no education. No one has built the premium, artist-led answer. In Australia, Quick Flick proved one clever eye tool can become a \$10M brand in 1,500 stores.

VISUAL DIRECTION

simple competitor map: two axes (disposable↔reusable, generic↔premium) with an open top-right quadrant marked with the gold arc.

Layout: headline + quadrant chart.

Lash Lock™

A reusable shield that catches the mess before it happens

A featherlight silicone crescent that hugs the curve under the eye, hands-free. Fallout lands in its catch channel — not on skin. Flip it for a liner straight-edge and mascara guard. Rinse, case, reuse for years.

VISUAL DIRECTION

*hero product render (brief 7.4)
captioned "concept render".*

Layout: product hero — image dominant, three-word benefits under.



Small tool, real engineering

Designed to be tested on real faces before we spend real money

Feather-thin edge that won't crease concealer · catch channel that shows what it saved · wing edge for liner · grip tab · skin-safe platinum silicone · wash-and-go hygiene · Duo Kit with case, mini brush and technique cards.

VISUAL DIRECTION

annotated diagram (spec view 1, 03_PRODUCT_SPECIFICATION.md).

Layout: centre diagram, feature callouts radiating.



Seat. Create. Lift. Done.

The demo is seven seconds long — that's the marketing, too

1. Seat the feather edge under the lashes. 2. Do the boldest look you know. 3. Lift away — tap the glitter into the bin. The base never knew it happened.

VISUAL DIRECTION

three-step sequence (in-use concept board, brief 7.7, labelled concept).

Layout: three panels, numbered.

What do we call the company?

Twenty names were scored. Two finalists.

Option A: Katch Beauty — because it catches fallout, and because it starts with you. Option B: Halo & Arc — elegant, geometric, quieter. (Lash Lock stays the product name either way.)

VISUAL DIRECTION

both wordmarks side by side (briefs 7.1 variants).

Layout: two cards, A/B.

Katch Beauty

Lash Lock™ by Katch Beauty

The recommendation: a house brand named for you, with room to grow past one product — and a first product that keeps its honest, descriptive name. Still to verify: trademark and handles (that's a this-month job, and names can change).

VISUAL DIRECTION

*Katch Beauty primary wordmark large;
gold arc glyph.*

Layout: logo showcase.



The arc is the idea

A crescent that catches one falling dot

No eyes, no lashes, no clichés. One thin arc — the product's silhouette — cradling a single caught particle. It embosses on silicone, foils on boxes, and reads at 16 pixels.

VISUAL DIRECTION

*icon (brief 7.3) at three sizes;
embossed-on-case mock.*

Layout: icon triptych.

Quiet luxury, working hands

Porcelain · Blush · Espresso · a whisper of gold

Warm, calm, premium — a brand that looks like your studio feels.
Sage green is reserved for the professional line.

VISUAL DIRECTION

five swatches with names, plus one styled flat-lay.

Layout: swatch row + image.



The unboxing is the second demo

Matte porcelain box, blush reveal, one gold arc

Two shields nested in a ventilated case, a mini fallout brush, four technique cards written by a working artist — you. Recyclable board, no plastic windows. It should feel like a gift, because for most buyers it will be one.

VISUAL DIRECTION

packaging mockup (brief 7.5), labelled concept.

Layout: image-dominant with three annotations.

Who buys this

Two customers, one problem

The glam lover (18–45): does event and occasion looks, lives on TikTok and Reels, redoes her under-eye weekly and hates it. The working MUA: faces this on every client, needs hygiene between faces, buys tools that save minutes. You speak both languages natively.

VISUAL DIRECTION

two profile cards with illustrative photos.

Layout: two-column personas.

The honest reasons to believe

And the honest risks

Believe: the demo is instantly convincing on video; disposables cost more over a year; no premium brand owns this space; your credibility is unfakeable. Risks: cheap copies will follow, and we must prove people will pay \$35 for engineered fit. That's why we validate before we spend.

VISUAL DIRECTION

two-column believe/risk list with icons.

Layout: balanced two-column.



A seven-second story, told a hundred ways

Education first, product second

One hundred content ideas are already written: the problem era, the build-in-public era, the launch era. Real demos only — an AI-honesty policy is part of the brand. The channel teaches clean application; the tool is the recurring hero.

VISUAL DIRECTION

mock phone grid of content thumbnails.

Layout: phone mock right, three era labels left.

Only the parts you want

A menu, not a rota

Product truth-teller (final say on "does this work on real faces") · the face and teacher on camera · pro-community bridge · creative director of look and feel. Any of these. All of these. None of these — and it can stay a side project we tinker on together.

VISUAL DIRECTION

four elegant menu cards.

Layout: 2×2 card grid.

I carry the boring bits

So the craft stays yours

Strategy, money, suppliers, website, logistics, legals, spreadsheets, customer service systems — mine. I take the financial risk. Where the business touches your name, your face, or your work, you get it in writing: pay, credit, a licence over your own likeness, and a documented path to ownership if this becomes ours together.

VISUAL DIRECTION

*simple two-swimlane role diagram
(James / Kat).*

Layout: diagram + one bold sentence.

We prove it before we spend it

Three gates, three budgets

Gate 1: post the problem, build a waitlist ($\approx \$600$). Gate 2: prototype on real faces, ask ten working artists ($\leq \$2,500$ total). Gate 3: only if 300+ people join and 30+ preorder — first small production run ($\leq \$7,500$ total). Miss the gates? We stop, having lost less than a weekend away.

VISUAL DIRECTION

three-gate pathway graphic with dollar caps.

Layout: horizontal timeline.

Made in our kitchen, tested on real faces

3D-printed moulds, skin-safe silicone, ten volunteers

Week one: sketches become a 3D model. Week two: we pour the first shields ourselves. Week three: ten faces — including working artists — tell us the truth. You'd be the chief judge of every version.

VISUAL DIRECTION

process strip: sketch → mould → pour → face test.

Layout: four-step filmstrip.

Small money, strict rules

All figures Australian dollars, all capped

Validation: ~\$600. Full validation: $\leq$ \$2,500. Launch (only after proof): $\leq$ \$7,500 — includes company setup, tooling, insurance, and the first 300 kits. Not spent early: ads, agencies, big inventory, fancy offices.

VISUAL DIRECTION

three stacked budget bars with padlocks on gates.

Layout: bar visual + rules list.

Premium, and priced to prove it

Estimated — the waitlist gets the final vote

Duo Kit \$34.95 · Single \$19.95 · Pro Kit \$59.95. It costs roughly \$8.50 to land a Duo Kit here — the margin funds honest content, quality parts, and eventually, people. A year of disposables costs more than one kit.

VISUAL DIRECTION

three price cards; small cost-per-use comparison chart.

Layout: pricing cards.

Four honest futures

Projections, not promises

Validation pace: ~\$1,000/month. Early brand: ~\$5,300/month.
Strong growth: ~\$24,000/month. Breakout (needs virality + retail):
~\$104,000/month. Each scenario lists exactly what must be true
first — and none of them are guaranteed.

VISUAL DIRECTION

four ascending columns with "what must be true" footnotes.

Layout: column chart + footnote band.



The first ninety days

Starting tomorrow, if you're in

72 hours: name checks, first problem videos. Week 1: sketches, designer briefed. Weeks 2-4: prototypes on faces, ten artist interviews. Day 60: the binding go/no-go meeting. Days 61-90: if GO — company, tooling, 300 kits, launch prep.

VISUAL DIRECTION

five-phase horizontal roadmap.

Layout: timeline.



One tool is a product. A system is a brand.

Where this can go

Pro Kit for artists → replaceable hygiene inserts → cleaning ritual set → Brow Lock, Lip Lock, the clean-application family. And a professional education arm with your name on it, if you ever want one.

VISUAL DIRECTION

product family tree from the arc glyph.

Layout: branching diagram.

What could kill it (we checked)

A red team attacked this plan on purpose

Copycats will come — so we file a design registration and build the brand they can't copy. Demand might be shallower than it looks — so gates block spending until proof. Cheap lookalikes exist — so we sell the system, not the paddle. And if the evidence says stop, we stop, on schedule, still friends with our money.

VISUAL DIRECTION

shield-and-gate iconography; council scorecard mini-graphic.

Layout: risk/mitigation pairs.



Go — after we prove it. Together, if you want.

And "not yet" is a real option

The professional verdict: GO AFTER VALIDATION. The personal one: this only works if it makes your life bigger, not busier. Yes, yes-but-smaller, not-yet, and no are all answers I've planned for. The company can wait. The idea keeps. You're the part that can't be replaced.



Happy anniversary, Kat

I didn't build you a business. I built you a beginning.

Whatever you choose, tonight I mostly wanted you to see what I see: someone whose skill deserves to be built around. The rest is detail. I love you.